

international DNA shines through as we bring together top expertise from diverse locations. Our goal is to deliver a software suite that competes with Microsoft Office 365, offering customers the option to be digitally autonomous, controlling their data and information sharing. This is especially important for government customers who require full control over their data and personal information. Our mission is to empower users with the right to determine the fate of their data.

Q. What do you mean when you say VNC is a leading developer of open source based enterprise applications? Is it different from open source software?

A. No, it is not. When you look at the VNClagoon suite, it is leading compared to any other open source-based communication and collaboration stack. Regarding this complete suite of communication and collaboration, and what we are doing, we are based upon open source platforms and technologies, and all our partners and customers have complete access to every line of code. We are open to audits and collaboration with partners who are developing their own solutions based upon VNClagoon. That is what we are doing with the software. It's auditable, open, and transparent.

Q. What is VNClagoon?

A. VNClagoon is the umbrella term for our software suite for secure communication and collaboration. This suite comprises approximately two dozen products, with one of them being VNCTalk, our secure alternative to WhatsApp or MS Teams. Another noteworthy product within our stack is VNCrm, a customer relationship management tool. In VNCcontacts, each contact is represented by an avatar, containing not only address information but also records of conversations. Furthermore, a user

can easily start activities in this action wheel such as a new chat or new call to the contact. All products and functionalities are integrated, stored, and centrally managed. VNClagoon is the overarching suite, and within it, we currently offer around 20 products, with the number continually increasing.

Q. How does your product range of solutions and services compare to what your competitors offer?

A. Two global giants stand as our primary competitors in the market with Microsoft Office 365 and Google Workspace. There are some other niche products in the open source space, but they lack the completeness and integration seen in Microsoft and Google offerings. We are confident that our product covers all the relevant functionalities provided by Microsoft in MS Office 365 and goes beyond in areas like sophisticated project management, archive integration as well as low-code/no-code technologies.

Our comprehensive groupware is comparable to Microsoft Exchange, with numerous successful migrations from Exchange to our VNCmail product. We seamlessly integrate file sync and share functionalities, akin to OneDrive or Dropbox, into our product stack. Our product, VNCchannels, combines elements comparable to Slack and SharePoint, offering content creation and collaboration. We have developed tools for software development, code management, and automated testing as well as project management, all fully integrated into our product stack. For instance, within our system, every interaction with individuals is stored and tracked, providing a complete history of communication methods used, whether it's email, chat, or video conferences. This integrated approach extends to customer relationship management (CRM), where each action within our product updates the corresponding avatar, providing a comprehensive



Bernd Rodler,
Community Leader, VNC

view of interactions behind the virtual equivalent of a person's identity.

Q. Could you explain the technology that allows you to view all interactions behind an avatar representation, and how does it benefit your customers?

A. To achieve this, we employ sophisticated technology in the background, such as an enterprise index called Solr. We chose Solr over Elasticsearch due to its scalability, used even by entities like Bloomberg. This powerful index allows us to query information from our backend tools and present it on the UI. This separation of backend functionality from the frontend sets us apart. We have our own frontend client, VNCuxf (user experience framework), based on open source Google Angular. This setup enables us, our customers, and partners